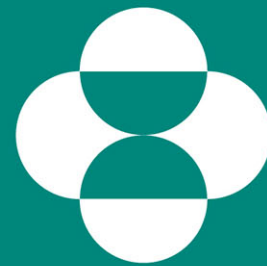


PERSPECTIVES IN CONTINUOUS BIOPROCESSING



MERCK

INVENTING FOR LIFE

BioNJ Manufacturing Briefing
21 September 2018

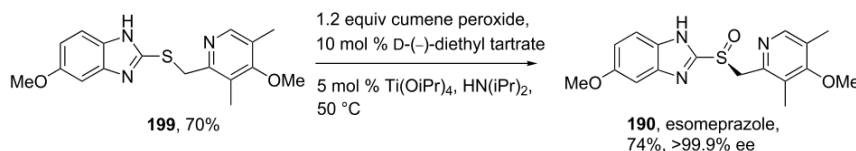
Mark Brower, Nuno Pinto, Adrian Gospodarek, William Napoli, Douglas Richardson

Biologics vs. Small Molecules

Small Molecules → Chemical Synthesis

Drug Substance (API)
Solid
Storage @ room temp
Unformulated

Drug Product
Tablets
Room temperature storage
Oral dosing



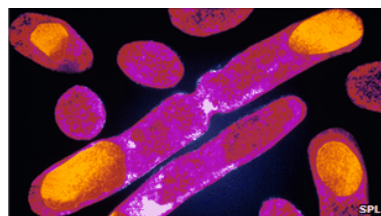
Biologics → Fermentation

Drug Substance
Liquid
Storage @ -70C
Formulated
Buffer, sugar, surfactant

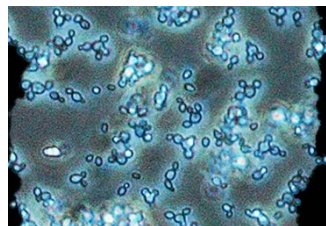
Drug Product
Liquid or lyophilized
Storage @ 5C
Intravenous or subcutaneous dosing



CHO Cells

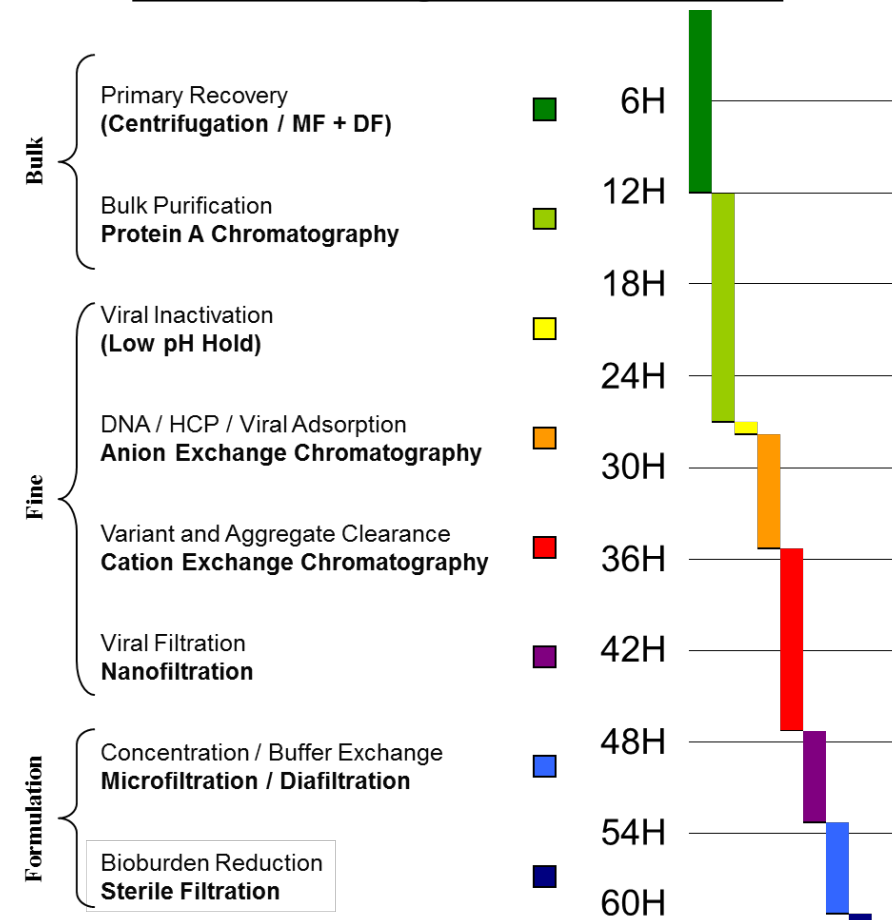


E. coli

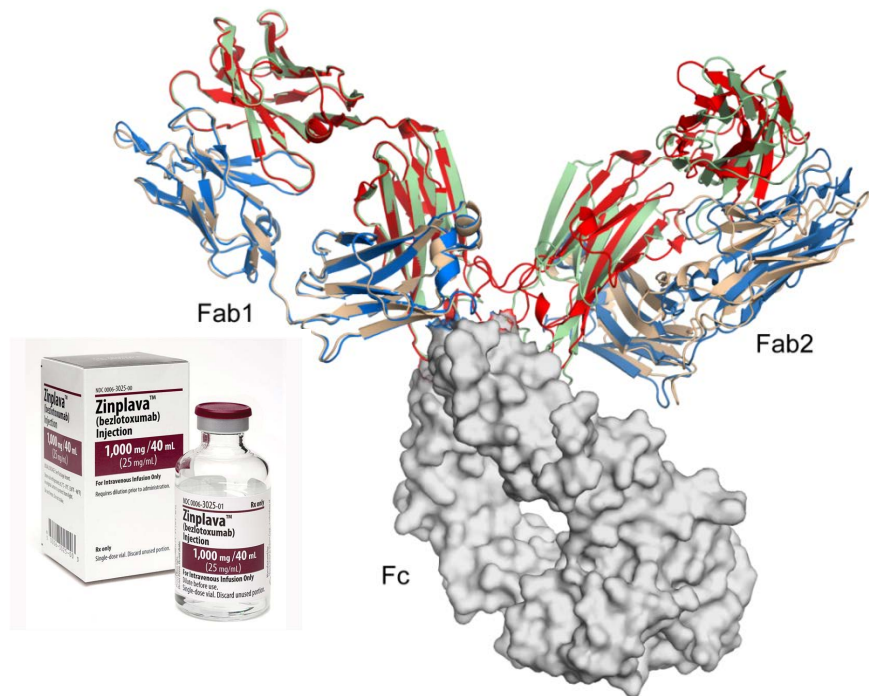


Pichia

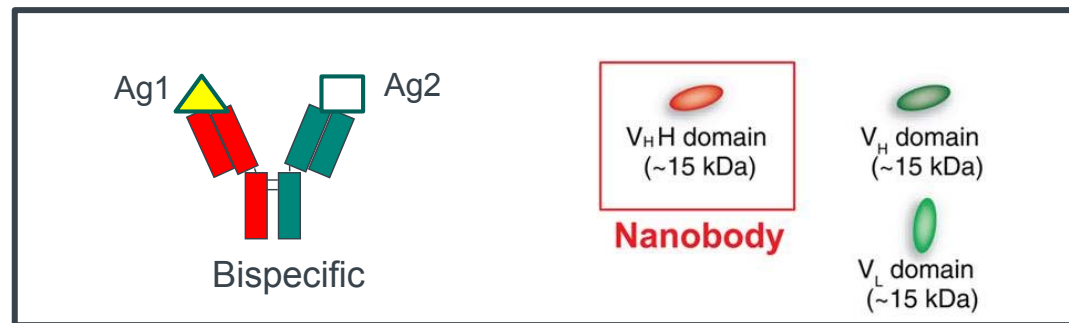
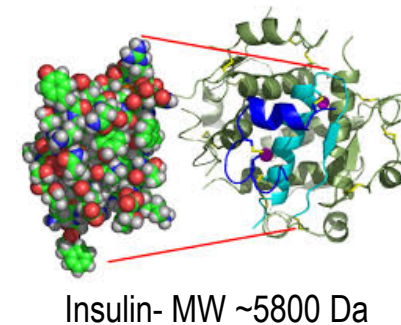
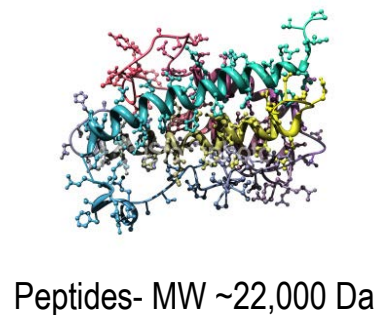
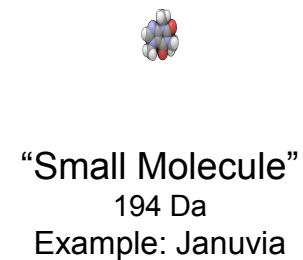
Typical Biologics Purification



Beyond Antibodies



Monoclonal Antibody (mAb)
~150,000 Da

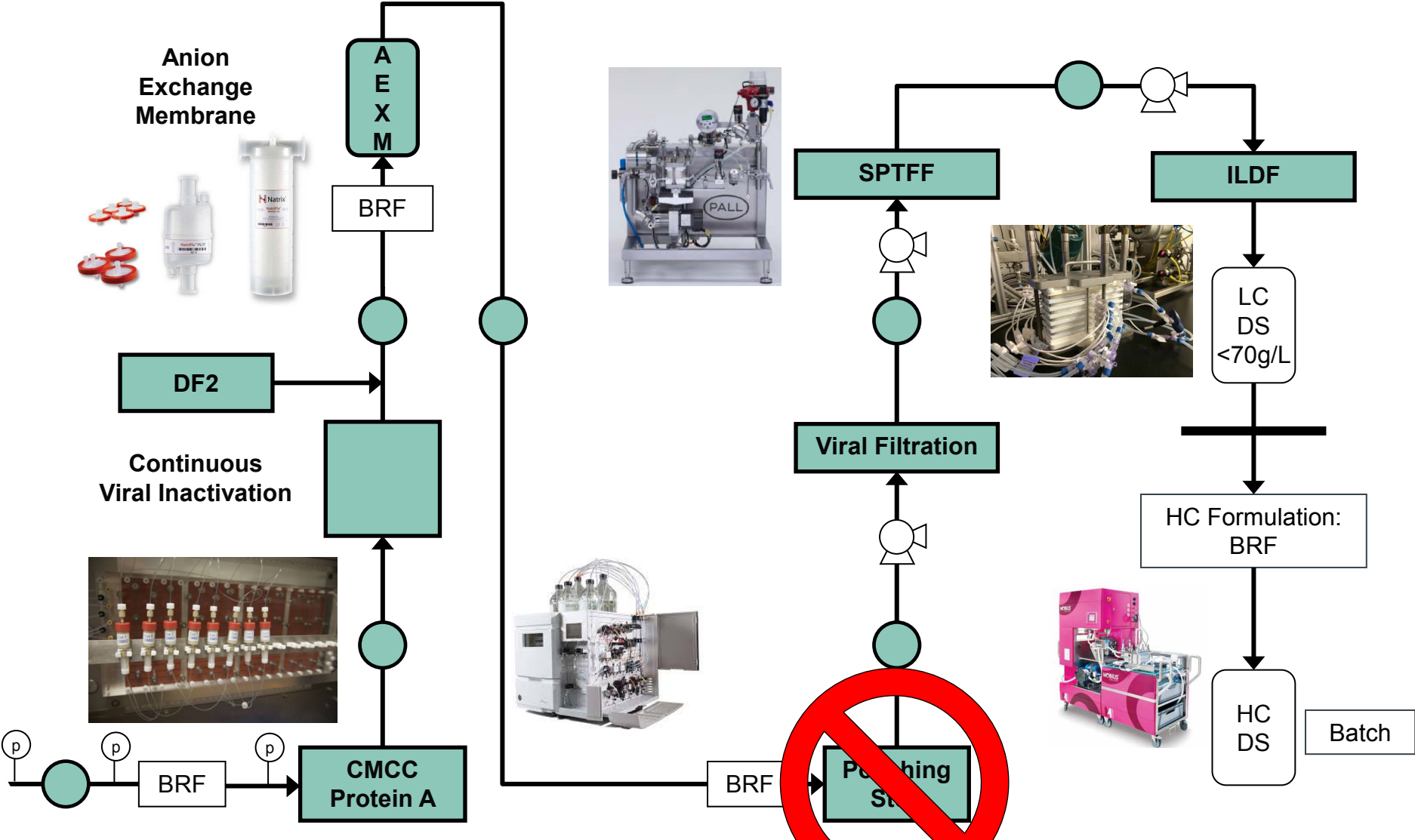


Continuous Processing Vision - 2,000L SUB*



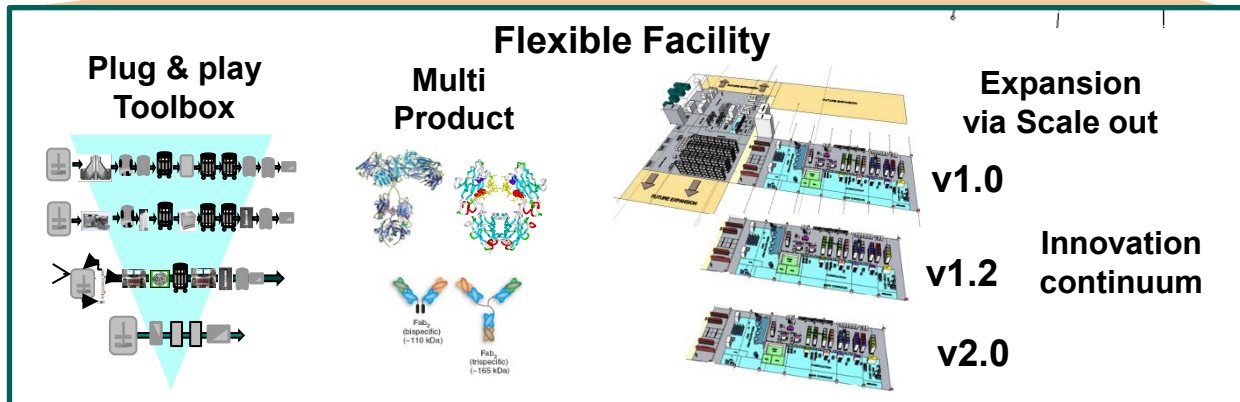
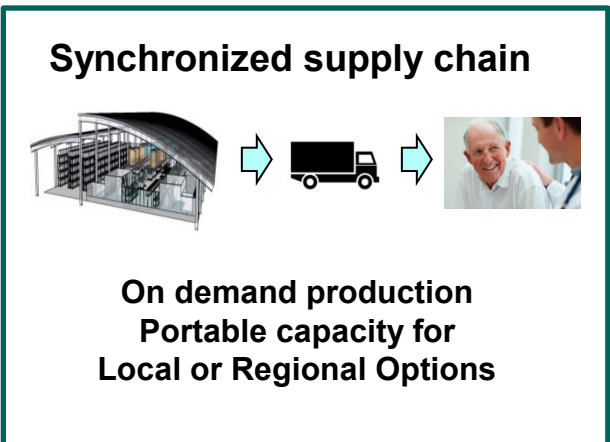
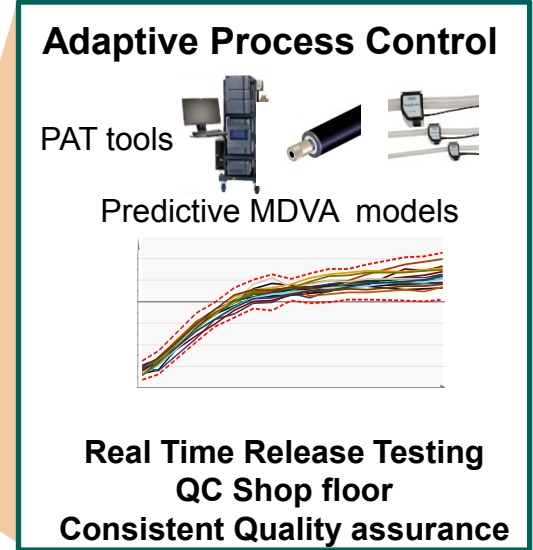
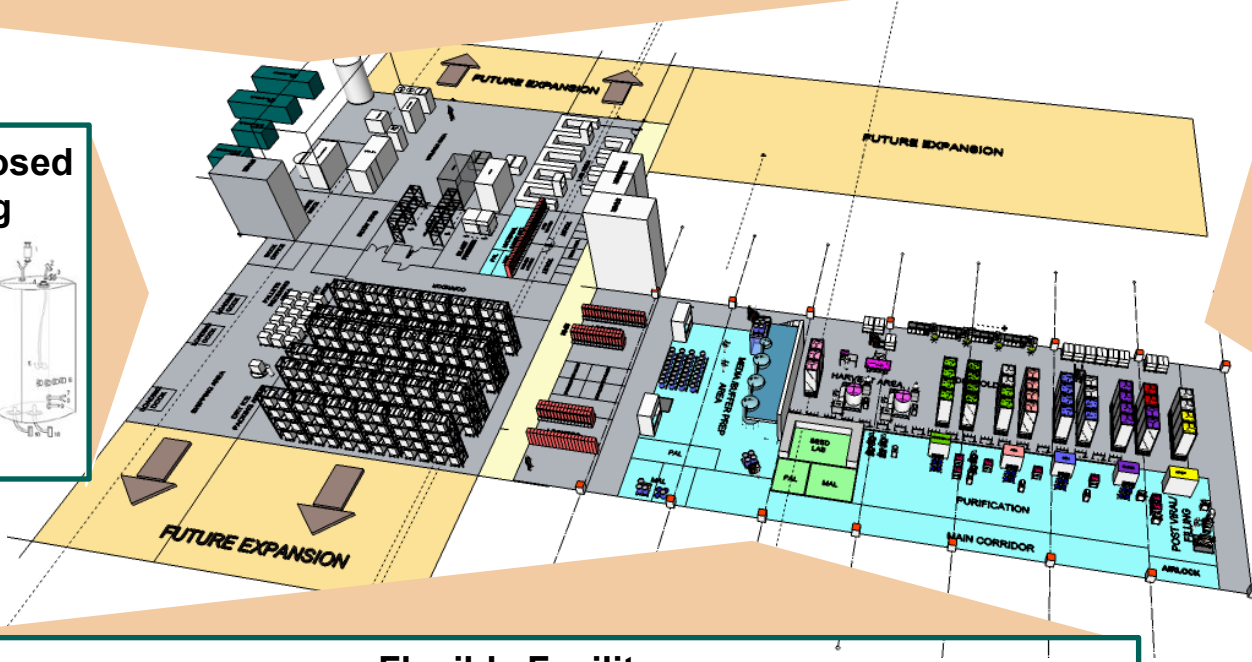
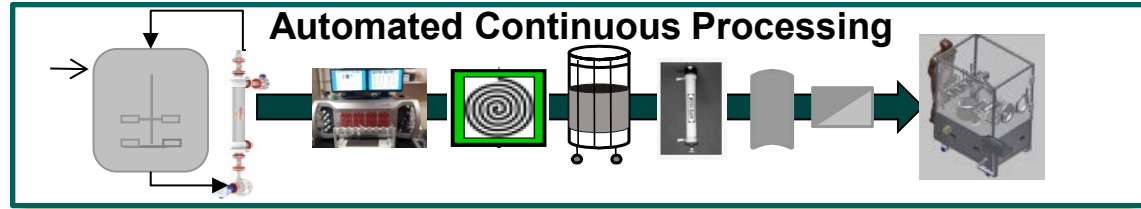
*Single-Use Bioreactor

● Single-Use Surge Vessel



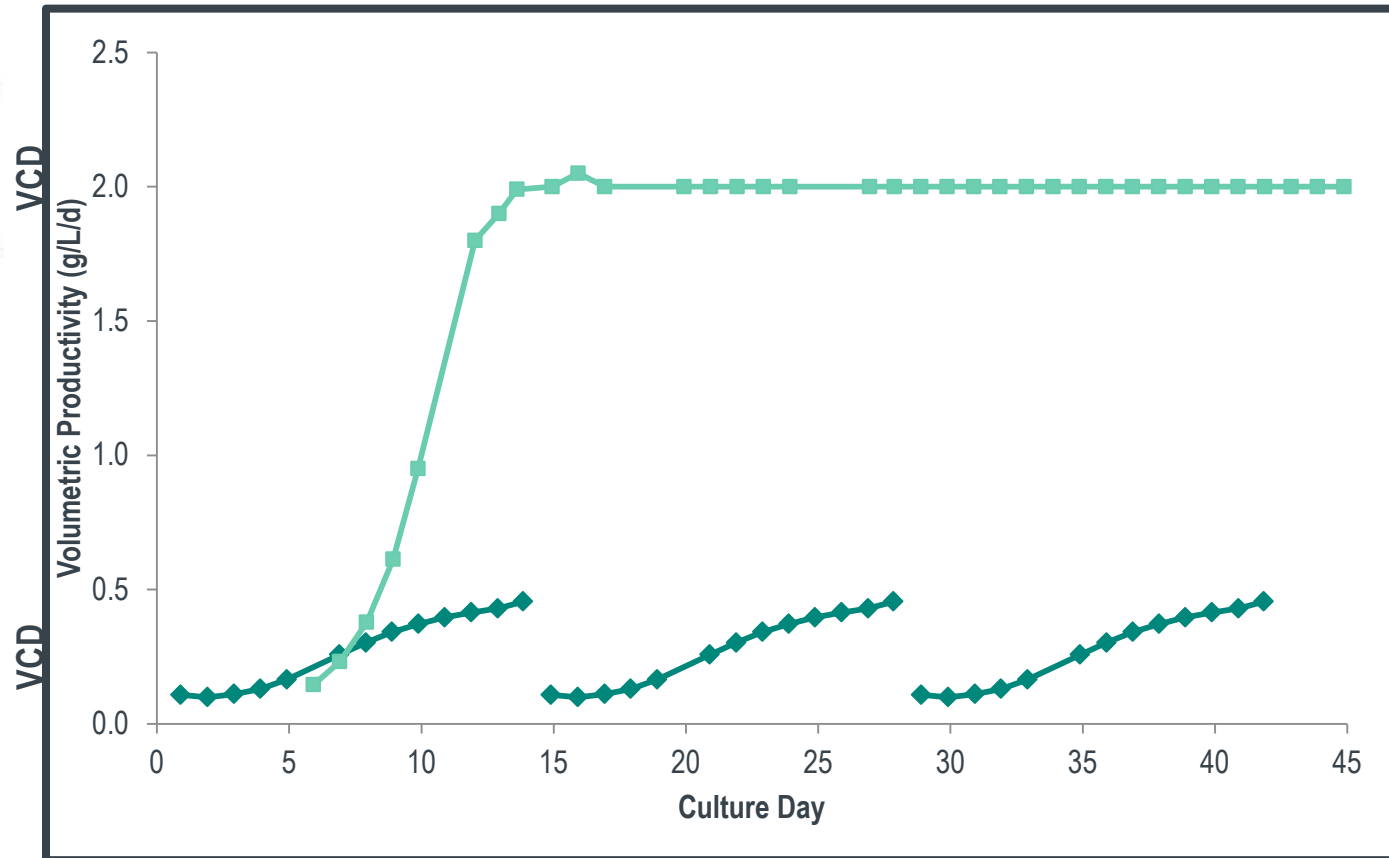
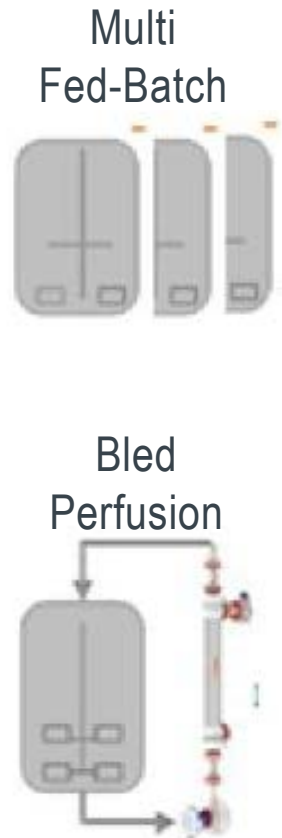
Overall DSP Time Cycle is Dictated by the Longest Step
Other Steps are Lengthened to Compensate

Vision for Biologics Agile Supply



Perfusion Cell Culture

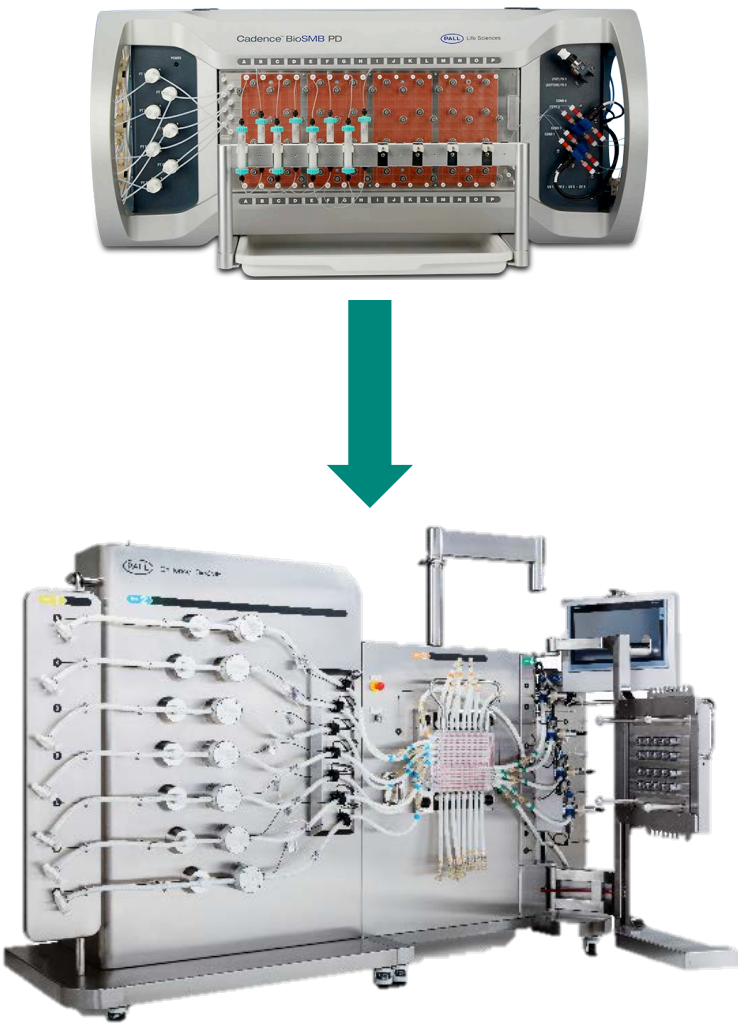
Quality vs. time: Mini-batch concept



Segmentation of a bled perfusion into mini batches with predictable product quality enables real-time release

Continuous Chromatography (mAb 1)

Process Comparison Across Scales & Modes



	Batch Reference	Cadence BioSMB PD	Cadence BioSMB Process
Product Concentration	9.54 g/L	13.84 g/L	13.85 g/L
Product yield	98%	97%	97%
Aggregate	0.45%	0.72%	0.65%
LRV DNA	n.a.	4.16	5.02
LRV HCP	2.4	2.6	2.5
Specific Productivity	16 g/(L·h)	56 g/(L·h)	56 g/(L·h)
Comparable Process			
Cycles	3	[6]	13
Column Diameter	40 cm	1.13 cm	14 cm
Column Height	16 cm	5 cm	5 cm
Adsorbent Volume	20 L	0.025 L	3.85 L
Flow rate	315 L/h	0.24 L/h	37 L/h

- Feed material: 400 L clarified cell supernatant with 5.8 g/L mAb
- Chromatography sorbent: KANEKA KanCapA Protein A media
- → 2.3 Kg from 400 L processed in 13 cycles over 11 hours

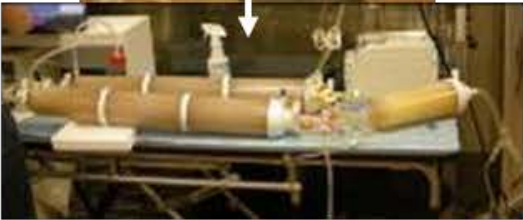
Continuous Processing Case Study (mAb 2)



SUB



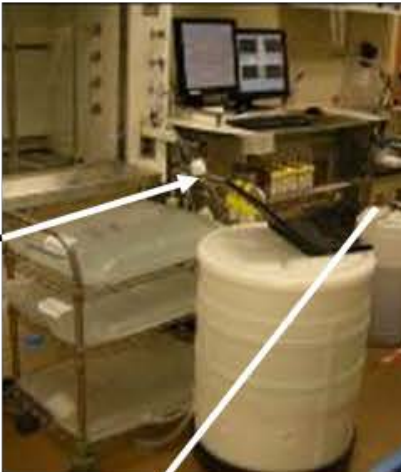
SU Centrifuge



DF / BRF



Harvest Bag



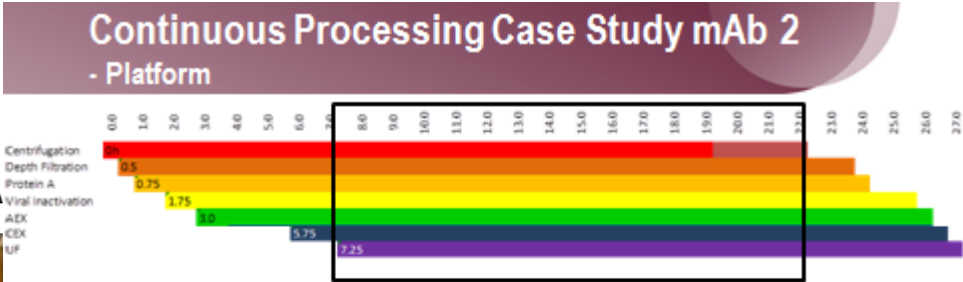
SMB Protein A



Viral Inactivation



Cation Exchange



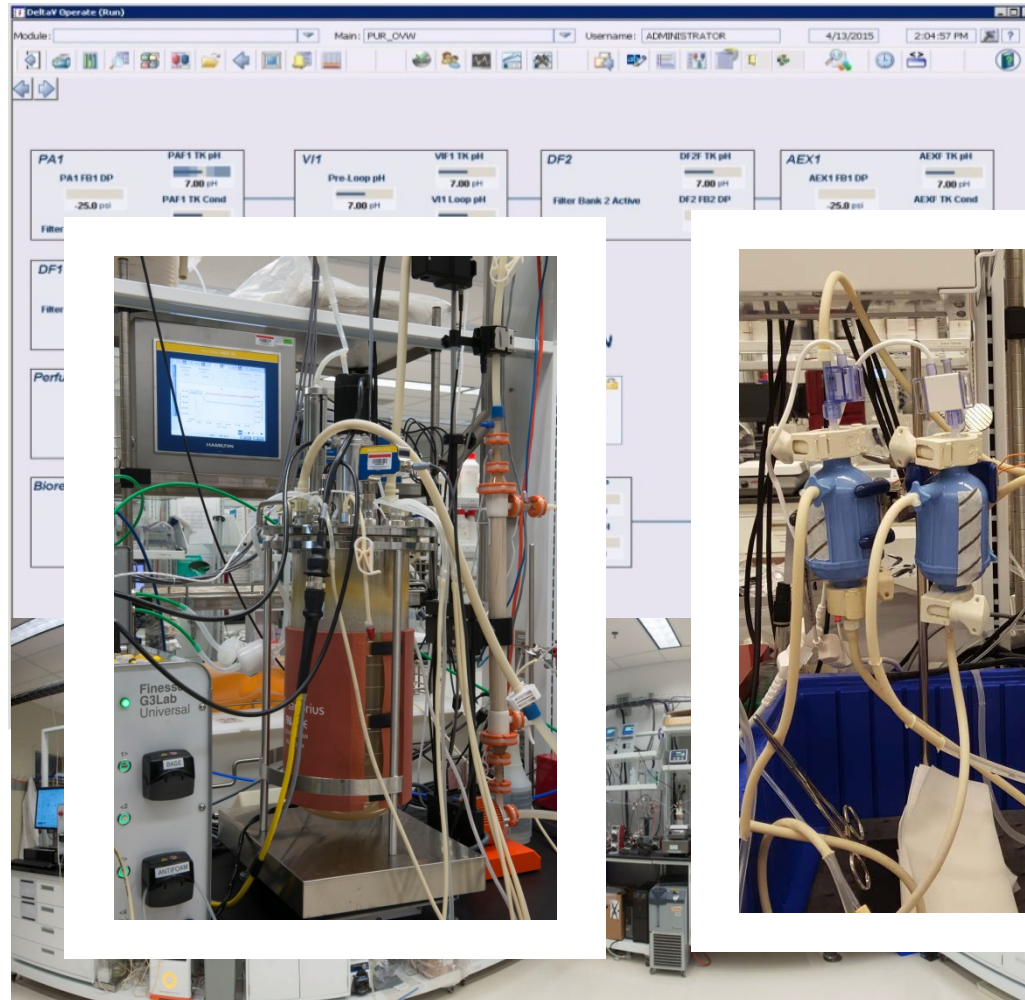
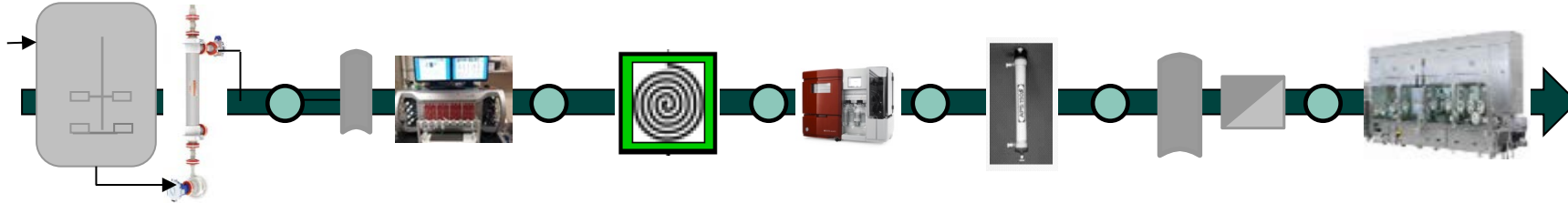
	Average Yield	DNA* [ppm]	HCP [ppm]	Res. ProA [ppm]	% Monomer
Centrifugation	97.3%	N/S	N/S	N/S	N/S
DF/BRF	98.6%	30,515	383,300	N/S	N/S
Protein A SMB	98.1%	N/S	N/S	N/S	N/S
Viral Inactivation	100%	2	1,063	2.1	89.8%
Anion Exchange Membrane	98.8%	<LOQ	82	1.5	99.0%
Cation Exchange Chromatography	84.2%	<LOQ	605	<LOQ	99.2%
SPTFF	99.5%	0.001	35	<LOQ	99.0%
Overall	77.9%	0.001	8.7	<LOQ	99.0%

Mass Balance = 93%

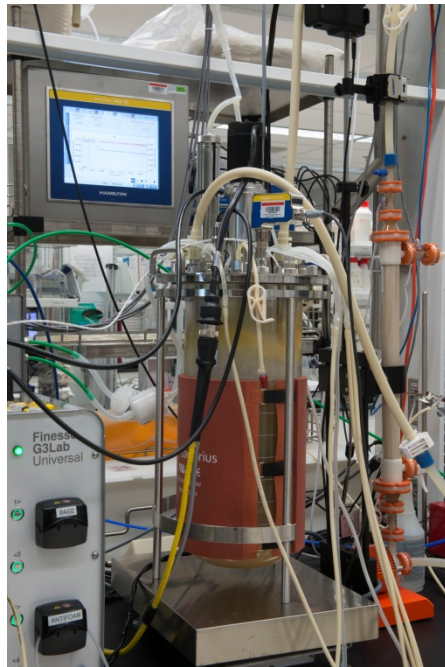
Be well

Automated mAb production:

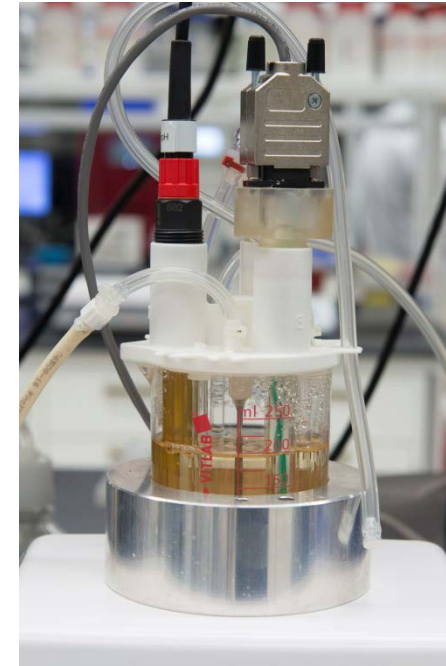
Protein Refinery Operations Lab (PROLab)



- Single Use Closed Processing
- Overarching Delta-V Control
- Integrated PAT / SIPAT Connectivity



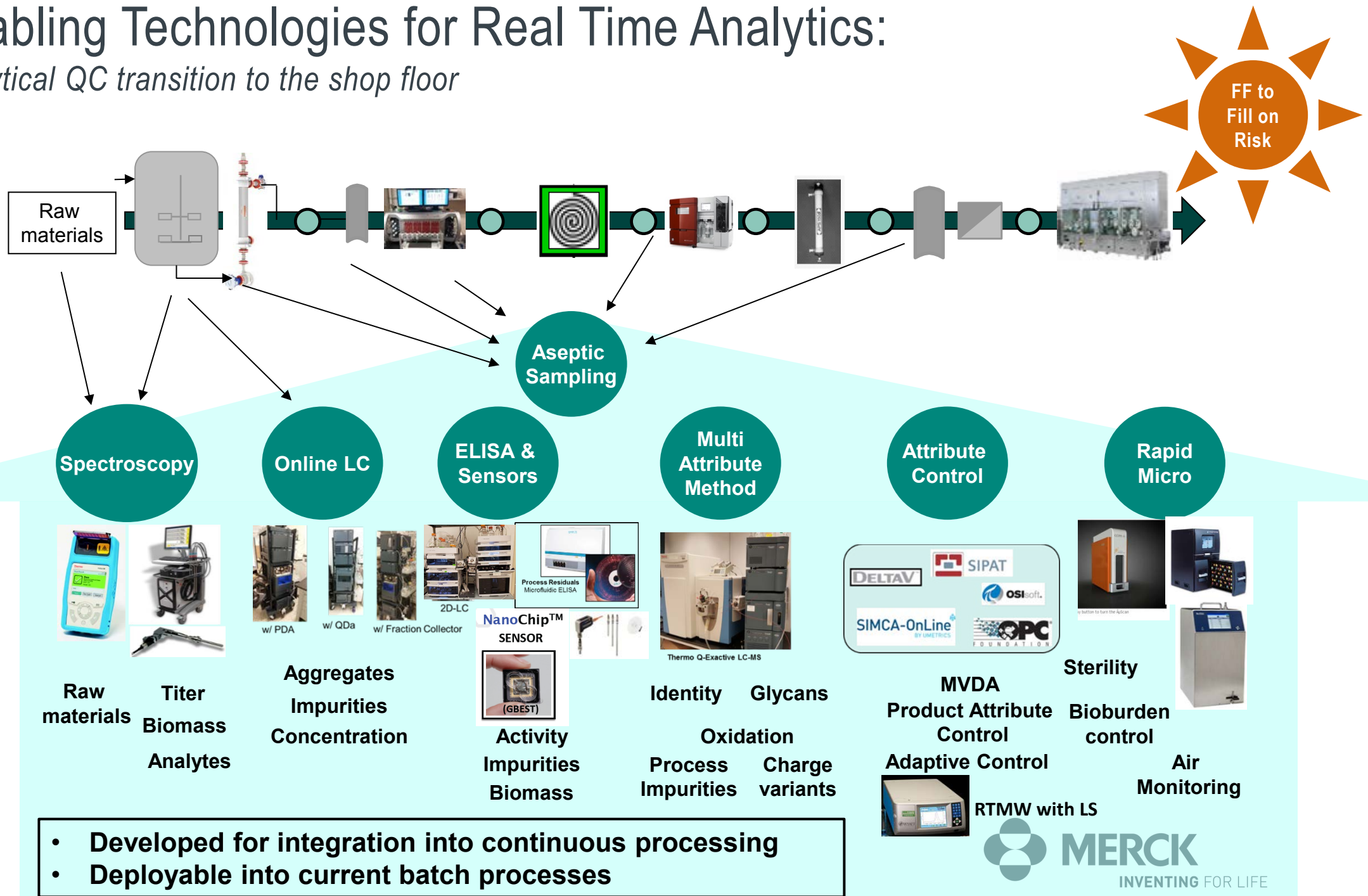
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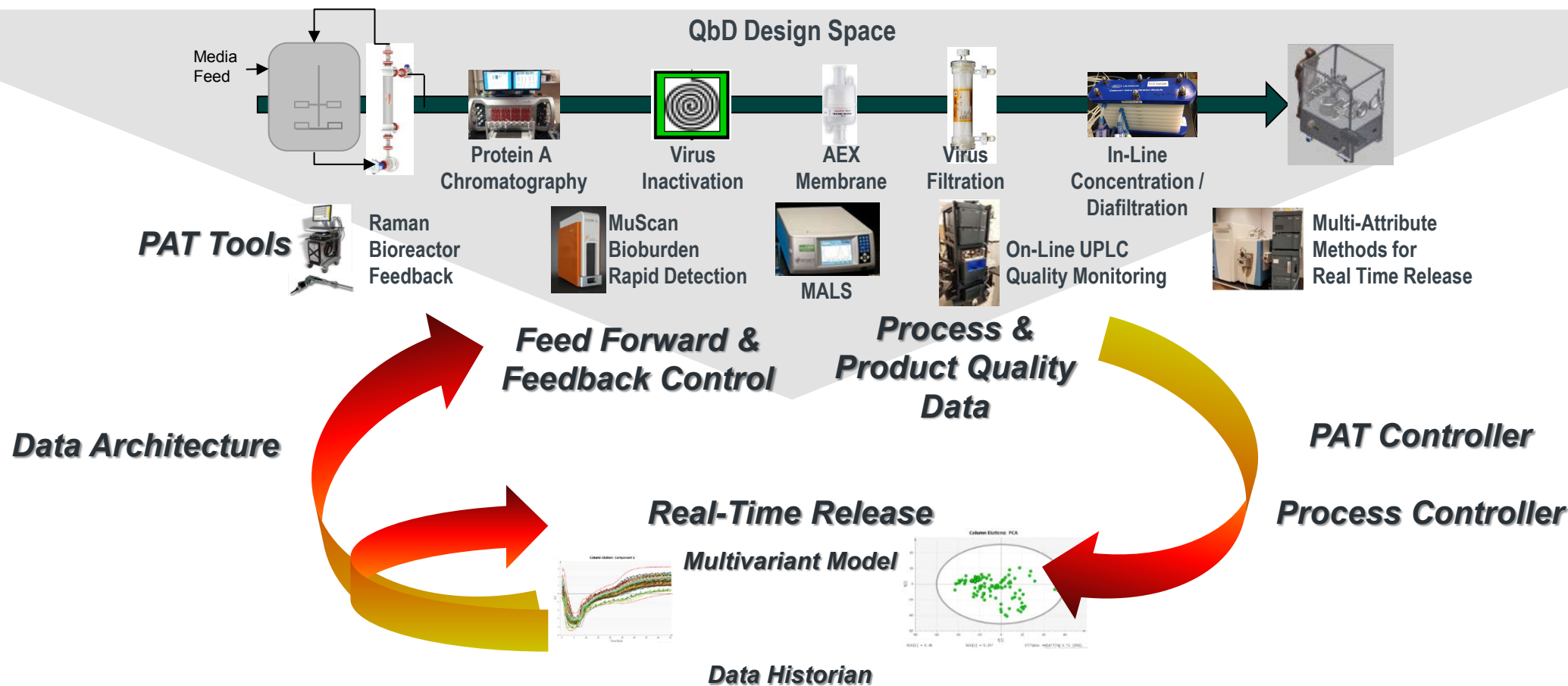
Enabling Technologies for Real Time Analytics:

Analytical QC transition to the shop floor



Process, PAT, and IT Toolbox

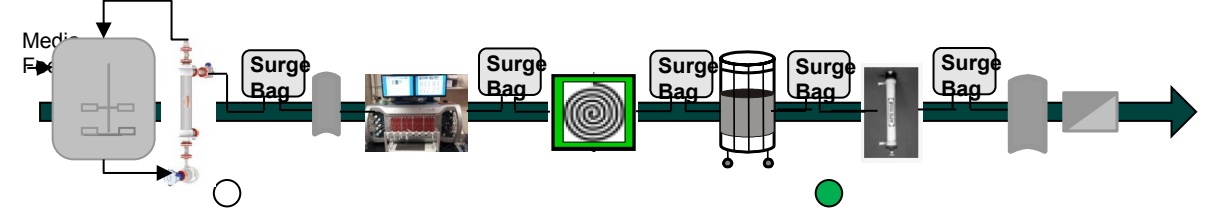
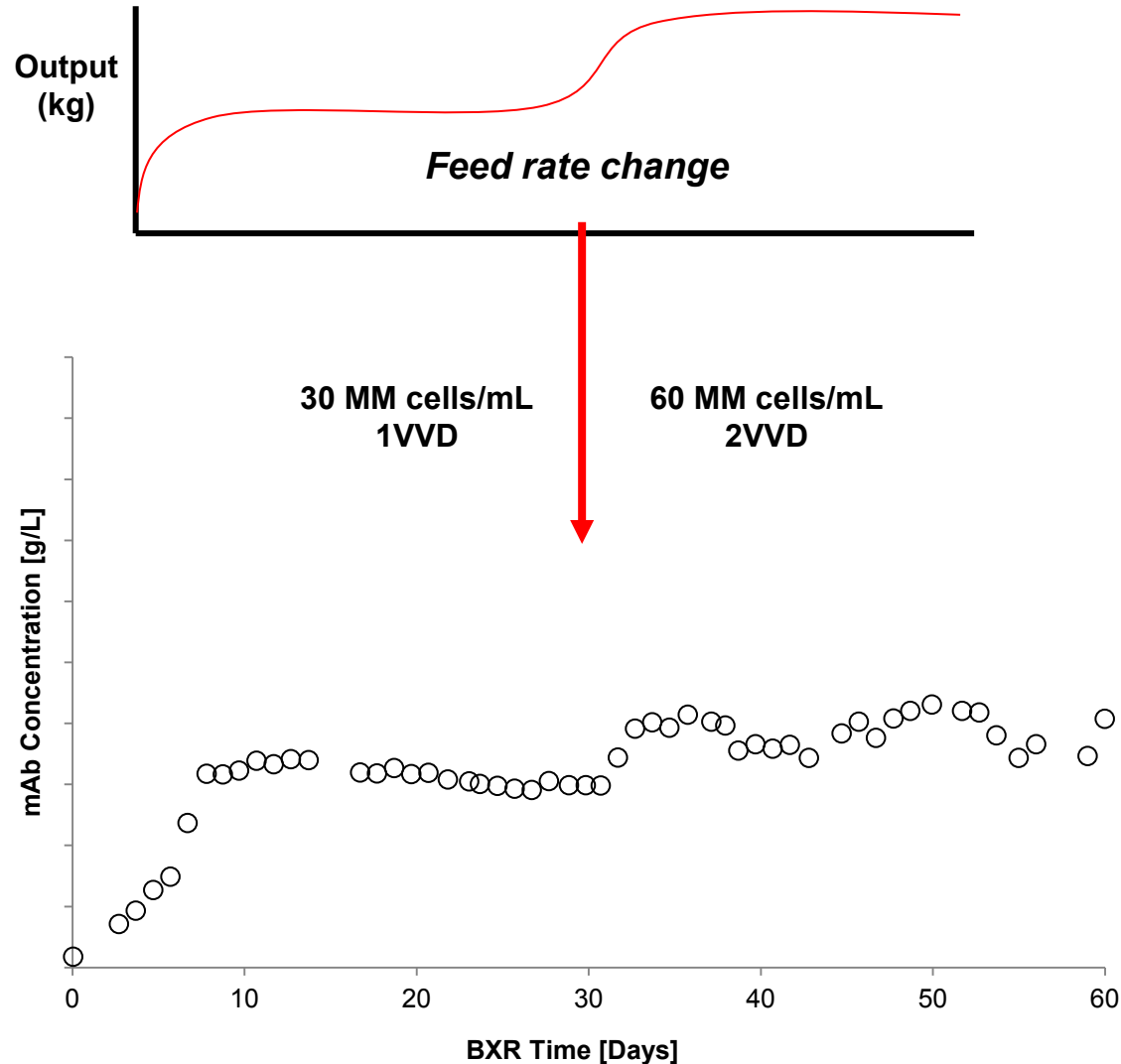
Connecting systems for robust operations



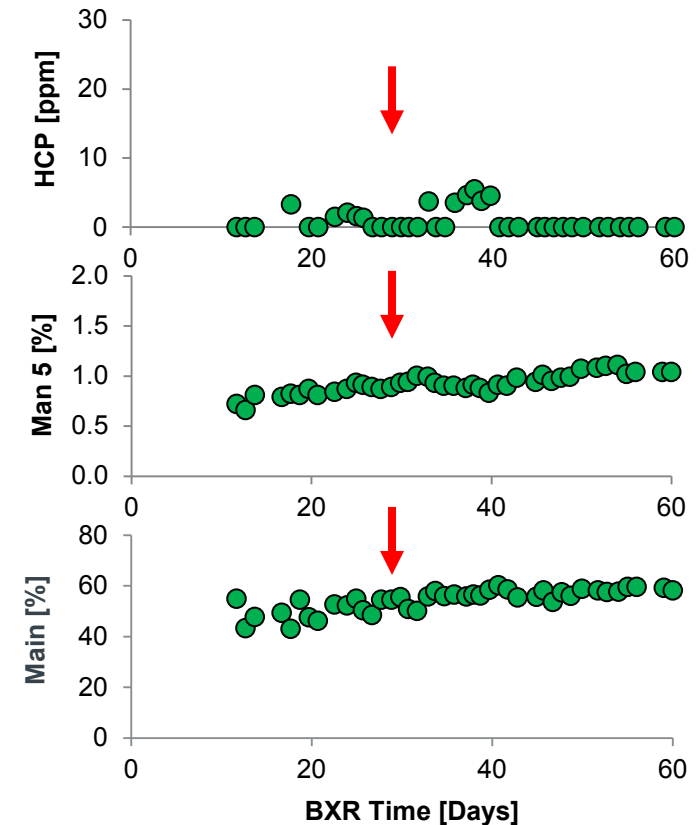
Continuous Downstream Operation

Process control for flexible drug supply

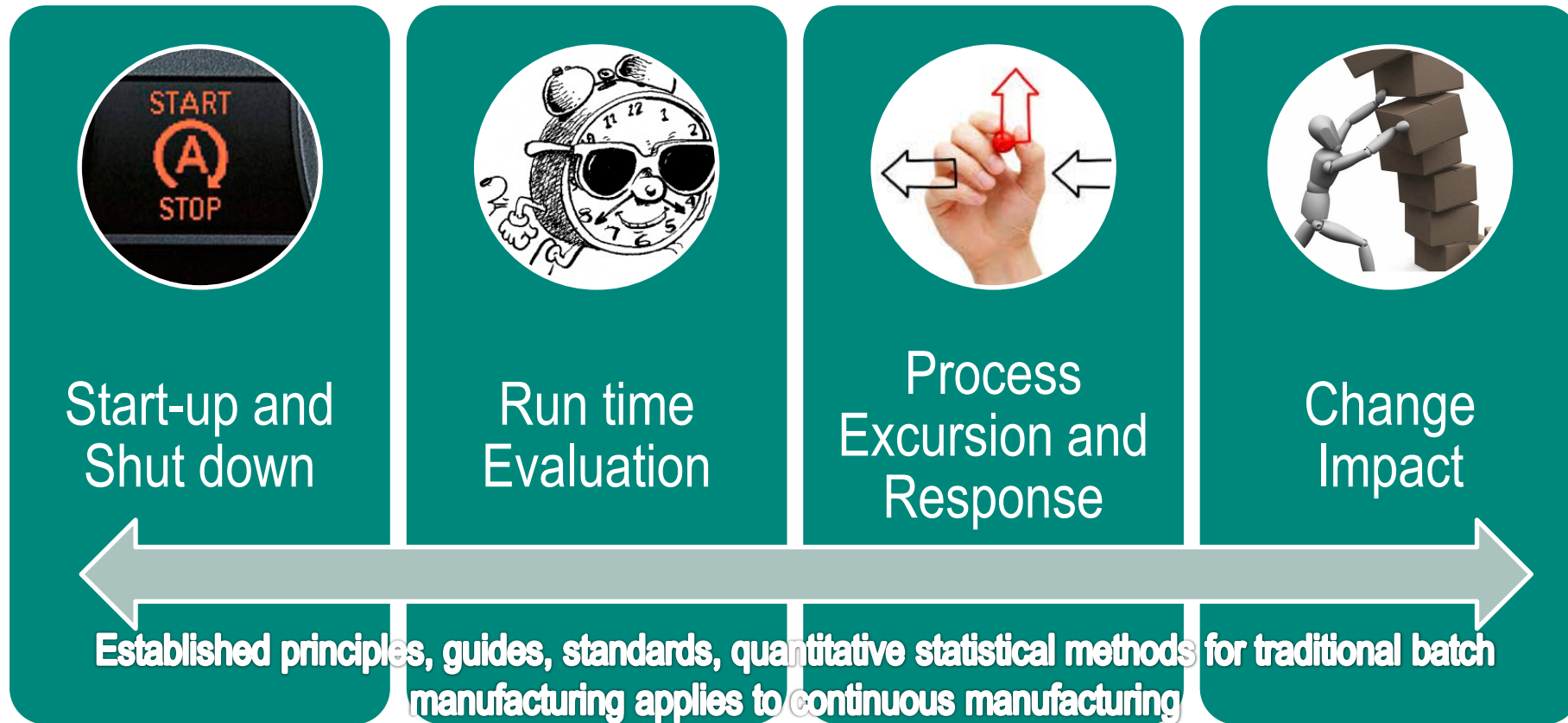
Perfusion feed rate increase to double kg output



Minimal impact to purity & quality



Process Validation for CM in Biologics-Under Control



Continuous process verification (per ICH Q8) as an alternative validation approach can use in-line, on-line, or at-line monitoring or controls to evaluate process performance

#vials thawed



*Curtesy of Lucy Chang: DIA 2018 Global Annual Meeting

Technical Challenges for Continuous Biologics (DSP)

- Facility design considerations
- Residence time distribution modeling
- Microbiology and Adventitious Agents control strategy
- Scale down models & change of PD workflows
- Viral safety validation
- Robust aseptic sampling and clarification technologies
- Demonstration of robust process scale GMP systems
- Robust single use sensors and consumables and supply
- Connectivity
 - Plug and Play automation solutions
 - Automated data movement and process control
 - Automation hurdles for lab scale systems

Process Integration

- Data standardization
- Linkage of discrete and continuous data
- Moving past batch mentality
- Robust and agile quality systems
- Electronic everything
- Development PAT to Manufacturing

Acknowledgements

Gregg Nyberg

Nihal Tugcu

PROLab Operations Group

Analytical Support Group

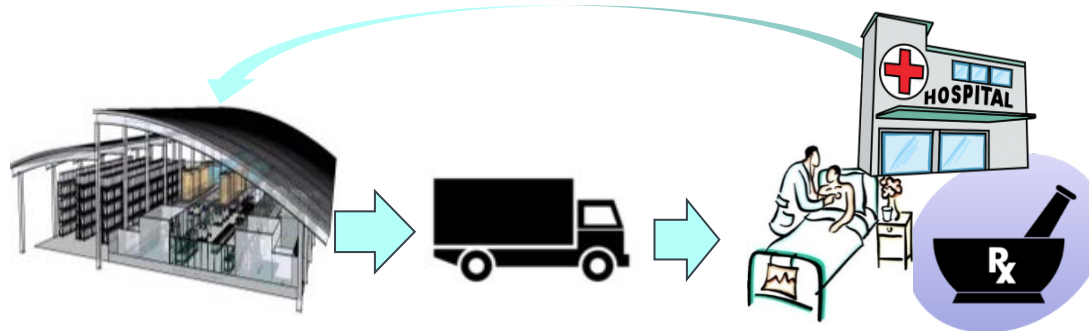
Lucy Chang

Christine Moore

Maury Bayer (Proconex)

Summary and Future Direction

- Merck PROLab designed as a fully automated continuous production suite for testing for next generation bioprocesses
- Continued development on a toolbox of processing platforms
 - Flexible 'plug and play' single use technologies
 - Working to implement new technologies into INDs
- Driving to :
 - Small modular agile facilities with embedded sustainability
 - Responsive synchronized value chain for adaptive clinical & commercial production with global reach



THANK YOU



MERCK
INVENTING FOR LIFE